

Single Line Working & Working by Pilot

Revision Guide

Source: GERT8000-TW1 Iss 22 | EMR SLW PPT 30-01 v8

1. What is Single Line Working?

When one line of a double-track railway becomes blocked, Single Line Working (SLW) by Pilot allows trains to travel over the remaining open line in both directions.

SLW is not necessary if the one remaining line is already bi-directional and can be used without specific SLW arrangements.

Key rule: Once SLW has been introduced you must ONLY enter the single line if you have the personal authority of the Pilot — you cannot enter on your own initiative.

2. The Pilot — Role and Identification

The Pilot is a competent person appointed by the local Network Rail Area Operations Manager to take charge of SLW arrangements.

Identification

The Pilot wears a red armband on their left arm with the word PILOT written on it in white letters.

The Pilot must:

- Be present to personally authorise any movement over the single line, unless the signaller is permitted to do so by the rules.
- Get the signaller's permission before authorising you to move onto the single line.
- Get the signaller's permission before authorising you to pass any signal at danger.
- Ensure there is enough room for trains to draw forward or set back at each end of the single line, clear of any necessary protection on the obstructed line.

Where a train is being worked by more than one locomotive at the front, the Pilot must show the driver's ticket to each driver, then give the ticket to the driver in the leading cab.

3. Working Under Instruction from the Pilot

You must make sure you clearly understand all instructions given to you by the Pilot. These instructions will include:

- Which line SLW applies over.
- Which crossover is being used at each end of the single line.
- Maximum speed limits over points.
- Whether a handsignaller has been provided to control wrong-direction movements back to the proper line.
- Whether you must pass AHB level crossings under local control only when a green handsignal is displayed.

The Signaller or Pilot will inform you when SLW has been introduced over a section of line.

4. Wrong Direction Movements

When your train is to travel over the single line in the wrong direction, you must tell the guard. The guard must take into consideration:

- Station working, releasing doors, and passenger safety.
- Protection arrangements if you have to carry out the requirements of module M1 (Dealing with a train accident or train evacuation).

Speed Limits — Wrong Direction

Location	Maximum Speed
On the single line (wrong direction)	50 mph
Over points (mechanically operated, unworked, or power-operated not secured)	15 mph
Over crossovers leading to/from the single line (first train)	15 mph

Signs are placed opposite the signal where trains return to the proper line. Controlled signals at the ends of the SLW section are kept at danger.

5. When the Pilot Must Accompany Your Train

The Pilot will accompany every train travelling in the wrong direction in the following circumstances:

Situation	Condition	Pilot accompanies every train?
No ESW sign, main aspect or stop signal provided to control move back to proper line	Always	Yes
ESW sign OR main aspect/stop signal IS provided	Good visibility	No — follows on subsequent train
No main aspect or stop signal provided	Poor visibility	Yes

When the Pilot accompanies, they ride in the leading cab. If not accompanying, they follow on a subsequent train.

6. Driver Duties — Wrong Direction Moves

Telling workers and crossing keepers

These actions are only required if the SLW arrangements have not been previously published or have altered:

- The Pilot (or you, if not accompanied) must stop and tell anyone working on or near the line being used for SLW that SLW has been introduced.
- If accompanied by the Pilot, you may need to stop to allow the Pilot to tell any crossing keeper about the SLW arrangements.
- The Pilot (or you if instructed) must check that points are properly secured.

Handsignals during wrong direction working

- Pass a handsignaller only if a yellow handsignal is displayed.
- Pass AHB level crossings under local control only if a green handsignal is displayed (as instructed by the Pilot).

CCTV, OD and RC level crossings in wrong direction

Where no attendant has been appointed, approach cautiously and do not pass over the crossing until you are satisfied it is safe to do so.

7. Returning to the Proper Line

When returning from a wrong-direction movement to the proper line:

Situation	What you must do
A main aspect or stop signal is provided at the return point	Obey that signal normally.
No main aspect or stop signal is provided	Stop and contact the signaller for arrangements about returning to the proper line.

8. Right Direction Movements

When travelling over the single line in the right direction (the same direction as normal), worked signals will be provided where possible.

You still require the personal authority of the Pilot before entering the single line, and must follow any instructions from the Pilot regarding speeds and crossings.

9. RT3193 — Driver's Single Line Working Ticket

The Pilot must give you a Driver's Single Line Working Ticket (RT3193) before you enter the single line.

You do NOT need the RT3193 if your train enters the single line to:

- Assist a failed train.
- Evacuate passengers from a failed train.
- Remove a portion of a divided train.
- Remove a train or vehicles that have proceeded without authority.

10. Level Crossings During SLW

The Pilot must instruct you how to deal with each type of level crossing. The rules are:

Crossing Type	Wrong Direction — No Controls Provided	Action
CCTV, OD or RC — no attendant appointed	Unless wrong-direction controls provided	Approach at caution; pass only if safe to do so.
Manned — crossing protected by signals	N/A	Pass only when authorised by handsignal shown at crossing.
Manned — gates/barriers normally across road	N/A	Pass when sure crossing is closed to road traffic.
Level crossing with red & green warning lights	Unless wrong-direction controls provided	Stop short of crossing, sound horn, pass only if safe to do so.
Barrow or foot crossing with white-light indications	Unless wrong-direction controls provided	Approach at caution; do not pass unless safe to do so.

11. Points and Crossings — Speed Rules

For all points, switch diamonds and swing-nose crossings in the wrong direction:

Points condition	Speed and approach
Mechanically operated	15 mph; approach at caution; check correct position if possible.
Unworked (no detection)	15 mph; approach at caution; check correct position if possible.
Power-operated, NOT secured and padlocked	15 mph; approach at caution; check correct position if possible.
Power-operated, secured and padlocked — first train	15 mph; approach at caution; check correct position if possible.
Power-operated, secured and padlocked — subsequent trains	Pilot tells you the location of each point where speed must be reduced below 50 mph. Follow those instructions.

12. Train Failure on the Single Line

If your train fails while on the single line and the Pilot is on board:

- The Pilot will arrange for assistance with the signaller.
- If the train is to be withdrawn back to the end it entered, the Pilot will obtain the signaller's permission to make this movement.
- The signaller will obtain the Pilot's permission before authorising an assisting train to proceed onto the single line.
- The Pilot will accompany the assisting train if it is coming from the rear and the disabled train is to be withdrawn to the rear.

If you have radio communication, be guided by the signaller about protection (normally assistance protection only is required).

13. Working to and from the Point of Obstruction

When both lines of a double-track route are blocked, a Pilot can introduce SLW over one line only to allow trains to work to and from the obstruction. Key points:

- SLW forms and tickets are amended to reflect this method of working.
- This arrangement can be introduced on both sides of the obstruction.
- Separate Pilots must be appointed for each side.

14. SLW on TCB — More Than One Running Line Available

On track circuit block (TCB) lines where more than two running lines exist, the Pilot may introduce SLW over one of the unobstructed lines if ALL of the following apply:

- There are more than two running lines.
- All lines in one direction are blocked.
- Two or more lines in the opposite direction remain open.

Under TW1 s33.2, if the SLW arrangements have not been published in the Weekly Operating Notice, you must tell the guard before travelling over the single line. Protection under M1 must take into account the altered direction of working.

15. Token and Train Staff Working (TW1 s34)

Principle

Only one train at a time is allowed in a single-line section (s34.1).

Getting and delivering the token or train staff

- You must always stop to get, deliver or exchange a token or train staff.
- Before taking a train onto the single line, get the correct token for that section from the signaller or person authorised in the Sectional Appendix.
- On a no-signaller token instrument, ask the signaller or authorised person to release the token.
- If a second locomotive is at the leading end, show the token to that driver before entering the section.

You do NOT need the token or train staff if:

- The line is under possession.
- Working by pilot is in operation.
- Modified working arrangements are in operation.
- You are authorised to pass the section signal on an electric token line at danger for shunting purposes.
- Your train is to enter the single-line section as an assisting train.

Handling the token in the cab

- Keep the token with you in the driving cab until needed by a shunter.
- If given to a shunter for shunting: do not continue until shunting is complete, points locked in correct position, and token returned to you.
- At end of section: give the token to the signaller or authorised person, or place it in the no-signaller instrument.

Train failure — token arrangements

- If your train fails and an assisting train is to enter from a ground frame released by the token, the signaller will instruct you to take the token to the ground frame.
- At the ground frame: contact the signaller, do not place the token in the instrument, reach a clear understanding of what is to be done, then hand the token to the driver of the assisting train.

Portions left in section

- If any portion is left in the single-line section, tell the signaller before you leave. Keep the token until the whole train is clear.
- If the signaller instructs the front portion to continue leaving the rear portion in section: give up the token or train staff.

Instrument failure

- If the signaller tells you token instruments have failed and the section will be worked as a one-train working line: handle the token as a train staff and do not place it in any instrument.

One-train working without a train staff (s34.4)

You must not enter or foul the single-line section until the controlling signal is cleared, unless:

- The line is under possession.
- Working by pilot is in operation.
- Modified working arrangements are in operation.
- Your train is to enter the single-line section as an assisting train.

If any portion is left in the section, tell the signaller and do not leave the section until you have done so.

Q&A — Test Your Knowledge

The following questions are based on GERT8000-TW1 Iss 22 and the EMR SLW rules.

Q1: What is Single Line Working, and when is it NOT necessary?

SLW allows trains to travel over one remaining line in both directions when the other line is blocked. It is not necessary if the remaining line is already bi-directional.

Q2: Who appoints the Pilot and how do you identify them?

The Pilot is appointed by the local Network Rail Area Operations Manager. They wear a red armlet on their left arm with the word PILOT written in white.

Q3: What must the Pilot do before authorising you to move onto the single line or pass a signal at danger?

The Pilot must first get the signaller's permission in both cases — permission to authorise you to move onto the single line, and separately, permission to authorise you to pass any signal at danger.

Q4: What is the maximum speed when travelling over the single line in the wrong direction, and what is the speed over points?

50 mph on the single line, and 15 mph over mechanically operated, unworked, or unsecured power-operated points.

Q5: Under what two circumstances must the Pilot accompany every train in the wrong direction?

(1) When no main aspect, stop signal or ESW sign is provided to control the move back onto the proper line. (2) In poor visibility, when no main aspect or stop signal is provided.

Q6: What must you (or the Pilot if accompanying) do for workers and crossing keepers when SLW is first introduced?

Stop and tell anyone working on or near the line that SLW has been introduced. Tell any crossing keeper about the arrangements. Check that points are properly secured. These actions are only needed if the SLW arrangements have not been previously published or have altered.

Q7: When returning to the proper line from a wrong-direction move, what must you do if no main aspect or stop signal is provided at the return point?

Stop and contact the signaller for arrangements about returning to the proper line.

Q8: What is the RT3193 and when do you NOT need one?

The RT3193 is the Driver's Single Line Working Ticket issued by the Pilot. You do not need it if your train enters the single line to: assist a failed train, evacuate passengers, remove a portion of a divided train, or remove a train/vehicles that proceeded without authority.

Q9: What must you do at a CCTV, OD or RC level crossing with no attendant during SLW in the wrong direction (where no wrong-direction controls are provided)?

Approach at caution and do not pass over the crossing until you are satisfied it is safe to do so.

Q10: Under TW1, when do you NOT need the token or train staff to enter a single-line section?

When: the line is under possession; Working by Pilot is in operation; modified working arrangements are in operation; you are authorised to pass a section signal on an electric token line at danger for shunting; or your train is entering as an assisting train.

Q11: Your train fails on the single line and the Pilot is on board. The decision is made to withdraw the train back the way it entered, using an assisting train from the rear. What happens regarding the Pilot?

The Pilot gets the signaller's permission to make the withdrawal movement. The signaller then gets the Pilot's permission before authorising the assisting train to proceed onto the single line. The Pilot accompanies the assisting train because it is coming from the rear and the disabled train is being withdrawn to the rear.

Q12: What are the three conditions that must ALL be met before the Pilot can introduce SLW on TCB over one line where more than one running line is available?

(1) There are more than two running lines. (2) All lines in one direction are blocked. (3) Two or more lines in the opposite direction remain open.